

SOF IEO — Topic Deep-Dive: Verbs & Tenses

For Ambar, Class III CBSE

1. What is a verb?

A **verb** is a doing word or a being word. Every sentence has one. - Doing words: *run, eat, play, write, sing* - Being words: *is, am, are, was, were* - Having words: *has, have*

Example: “Ravi **plays** cricket.” / “Riya **is** happy.”

2. The three tenses Ambar must know

Tense	When it happens	Signal words	Example
Simple present	Habits, facts	every day, always, usually	Ravi goes to school every day.
Present continuous	Happening NOW	now, right now, Look!, Listen!	They are playing cricket now.
Simple past	Finished action	yesterday, last week, ago	Meena ate a mango yesterday.
Past continuous	Was going on in the past	when, while	We were watching TV when Papa came.

The signal word decides the tense. IEO almost always plants one: “yesterday” forces past, “every day” forces present, “now / Look!” forces continuous.

3. The helping-verb table

Helper	Use with	Time
is	he, she, it, one thing	present
am	I	present
are	you, we, they, many things	present
was	he, she, it, I	past
were	you, we, they, many things	past
has	he, she, it	present
have	I, you, we, they	present
does / do	he-she-it / all others	present questions and “not”
did	everyone	past questions and “not”

Key rule after does/did/do: the main verb goes back to base form. “Does your brother **like** cricket?” — never “likes” after “does”.

4. Subject-verb agreement (the -s rule)

- **One person or thing → verb takes -s:** The sun **rises**. She **brushes**.
- **Many, or I/you → no -s:** The stars **shine**. My grandparents **live** in Amritsar.
- **Two subjects joined by “and” → plural verb:** Riya and I **are** friends. My brother and my cousin **play** carrom.

- **Each of / Every one of / Neither of → singular verb:** Each of the boys **has** a bat. Neither of the girls **knows** the answer.
 - **Neither A nor B → verb agrees with the nearer one:** Neither Ravi nor his brothers **want** to play.
 - **Collective words (team, class, family) → usually singular:** The team **has** won.
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5. Common traps

Trap	Wrong	Right
-s on the wrong verb	Ravi go to school daily.	Ravi goes to school daily.
Double -s after does	Does he likes it?	Does he like it?
was/were mix-up	The children was playing.	The children were playing.
have/has mix-up	She have been my friend.	She has been my friend.
“and” subject + singular verb	Rohan and Aman is here.	Rohan and Aman are here.
Ignoring the signal word	Yesterday she goes home.	Yesterday she went home.
Made-up past forms	bringed, flys, goed	brought, flies, went

6. High-frequency IEO question types

1. **Fill the blank with a signal word present** — “Last Sunday, we ____ to the zoo.” (went)
 2. **is/am/are/was/were choice** — “Look! The baby ____ crying.” (is)
 3. **Find the error** — one underlined part has the wrong verb (“The children **was** playing”).
 4. **Choose the correct sentence** — four versions, only one has the verb right.
 5. **Double blank (Achiever’s)** — “Ravi ____ his lunch when the phone ____.” (was eating, rang) — solve each blank separately, then match the pair.
 6. **Which sentence is in the past continuous?** — look for was/were + -ing.
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7. Key facts checklist

- Verb = doing/being word; every sentence has one.
 - One doer → verb with -s; many doers → verb without -s.
 - is (one) / am (I) / are (many); was (one) / were (many).
 - has (he, she, it) / have (I, you, we, they).
 - After does, do, did → base verb, no -s, no -ed.
 - yesterday, ago, last → past; every day, always → present; now, Look! → continuous.
 - Irregular pasts to memorise: go-went, eat-ate, bring-brought, sing-sang, take-took, leave-left, light-lit, drink-drank.
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8. Quick drill (10 questions)

1. Ravi ____ his homework every evening. (do / does / doing / done)
2. Yesterday, the girls ____ rangoli. (make / makes / made / making)
3. Listen! Someone ____ at the door. (knocks / is knocking / knocked / knock)
4. I ____ seven years old. (is / am / are / be)
5. The cows ____ grazing when it started to rain. (was / is / were / are)
6. Each of the players ____ a cap. (have / has / are having / were)
7. Does Meena ____ paneer? (likes / liked / like / liking)
8. My parents ____ in Delhi. (works / work / is working / working)
9. Find the error: “She **have** a red cycle.” (She / have / a / red cycle)
10. Choose the pair: “The sun ____ when we ____ home.” (was shining, reached / is shining, reached / was shining, reach / shines, reached)

Answers: 1. does 2. made 3. is knocking 4. am 5. were 6. has 7. like 8. work 9. have (should be *has*) 10. was shining, reached